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TOP SECRET REPORT ON SMOKING RISKS

Yorkshire Post Haregate Staff

AFTER FOUR years' research into smoking and health at its Haregate laboratories, the Tobacco Research Council is preparing a report, which unofficial sources state will strengthen the evidence of a link between cigarettes and lung cancer.

But a "security blackout" hangs over the Haregate laboratories. No one is allowed to comment on the work and methods of the following team of scientists and laboratory assistants.

A weekend report from an unofficial source said cancerous tumours have been produced in mice at a relatively high rate by using substances derived from tobacco.

It remains to be established whether these cancer-causing agents pass into cigarette smoke and if they cause cancer in human beings.

'Own conclusions'

Mr. H. B. Grier, secretary of the Tobacco Research Council, said in London: "In accordance with common scientific practice the research is now undergoing the usual refereeing procedure before publication in a scientific journal."

"Medical scientists will be able to form their own conclusions from the information. Suggestion that we are suppressing the report are totally inaccurate. It is not our policy to conceal any research."

The Haregate laboratories were built in 1962 at a cost of more than £250,000, after a Royal College of Physicians statement had drawn public attention to the link between cigarette smoking and lung cancer.

Machines which can "smoke" 600 cigarettes a day and specially bred mice are used in the experiments.

MINISTRY IN TALKS

● A spokesman for the Imperial Tobacco Company yesterday confirmed that talks are going on with the Ministry of Health over coupon brands.

But he declined to comment on a report that the Minister is expected to ask the company, Gallaher and Carrera, for agreement not to launch any new coupon brands.

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